# 4.12 Valvular Heart Disease and Valve Replacement

| Assessment | Nursing Diagnosis | Plan / Expected Outcome | Nursing Interventions | Evaluation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Subjective**<br>• "I get breathless on exertion."<br>**Objective**<br>• Murmur<br>• Cannot exercise as much as before<br>• Crackles | **ACTUAL**<br>**Decreased cardiac output** related to valve dysfunction as evidenced by dyspnea and murmur. | Hemodynamics stable after the valve surgery. | • Follow vital signs, ECG and urine output.<br>• Watch for signs of heart failure.<br>• Give the prescribed medications. | Hemodynamics stable: **goal met**. |
| **Subjective**<br>• "How long will I take warfarin?"<br>**Objective**<br>• Has a mechanical valve<br>• Just starting warfarin | **ACTUAL**<br>**Deficient knowledge** related to lifelong anticoagulation as evidenced by questions. | Can tell you the INR target, what to watch in the diet, and the signs of bleeding. | • Explain that warfarin is lifelong with a mechanical valve.<br>• Teach the need for regular INR checks.<br>• Tell her not to suddenly change how many green leafy vegetables she eats, and to check before starting any new medicine.<br>• Tell her to let the dentist know before any procedure. | Explains her anticoagulation: **goal met**. |
| **Subjective**<br>• *No specific complaint*<br>**Objective**<br>• Has a prosthetic valve<br>• Teeth and gums poorly cared for | **RISK**<br>**Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: prosthetic valve (endocarditis). | Can explain that she needs antibiotic prophylaxis as advised and good oral hygiene. | • Teach daily care of teeth and gums and regular dental check-ups.<br>• Before any procedure, she should tell the dentist or doctor about the valve.<br>• Tell her to report a fever quickly. | States the precautions: **goal met**. |